West-Oak Runs Wild, Secures Second Shutout
By Caleb James
For The Journal
GREENWOOD — West Oak's ground game was on point and its defense punished the Greenwood Christian School Hawks on Friday night, as the Warriors rolled to a 27-0 shutout win over the Hawks to close their non-region schedule with a statement win.

The victory gave West-Oak (4-2) its second shutout of the season, matching a 29-0 opening night victory over the Greenville Hurricanes and pushed the Warriors to four wins for only the second time since 2010. The last West-Oak team to record two shutouts in a single season was the 1998 squad, adding another layer of history to a night that belonged to the Warriors in every way.

Warriors Head Coach Glen Padgett called the victory "a big, big team win" against a Hawks squad that entered the game 5-1. "That was a good football team, they were 5-1 for a reason…but our defense really played great against a prolific offense."

West-Oak wasted no time taking control. The Warriors scored twice in the final 4 minutes of the first quarter, beginning with a 28 yard run from junior quarterback Harry Burgess at the 3:13 mark. After the defense forced a quick punt, Senior running back James Coltrane powered through the middle of the field for an 11-yard touchdown run with 35 seconds remaining in the first quarter to give the Warriors a 14-0 cushion going into the second quarter.

The second quarter brought more of the same. Sophomore running back Carter Fountian, who entered the night fresh off a 122-yard effort against Landrum the previous week, sliced through the Hawk's front for a 17-yard touchdown midway through the quarter to stretch the Warrior's leadto 21-0.

While the offense kept grinding, West-Oak's defense smothered Greenwood Christian (5-2). The Hawks, who had scored at least 2 touchdowns each game this season before Friday night, were held to only 233 total yards. Greenwood quarterback Leland Reed completed just 5 of 18 passes for a total of 65 yards and was picked off twice as the Warrior's defense stayed disciplined.

"They were averaging like 35 points per game, and they've got some outstanding receivers,"Padgett said. "But our defense played great."

West-oak added some insurance in the third quarter when sophomore receiver Jake Williams slipped through an opening down the sideline for a 10-yard touchdown run with 7:43 left, making it 27-0. From there, the Warriors leaned on their outstanding run game to run the clock down and seal the shutout.

The Warrior's ground game was relentless. Coltrane led the way with 106 yards on 21 carries, while Burgess and Fountain each added 90 yards on 6 and 10 carries. In all, West-Oak stacked up 342 rushing yards on 43 carries. Burgess also threw for 64 yards on 3-of-8 passing, with Williams hauling in two catches for a total of 38 yards.

"I felt like our offensive line played great, and both our running backs and Harry did a great job of running the ball," Padgett said.

With two shutouts already in the books, West-Oak now turns to face a daunting region schedule starting next week at top-ranked Belton-Honea Path and the Warriors believe they have the momentum to meet the challenge head-on.

West-Oak 27, Greenwood Christian 0

WOHS 14 7 6 3 — 27

GCS 0 0 0 0 — 0

SCORING SUMMARY

First Quarter

WOHS — Burgess 28 run (Vargas kick), 3:13

WOHS — Coltrane 11 run (Vargas kick), 0:35

Second Quarter

WOHS — Fountain 17 run (Vargas kick), 7:20

Third Quarter

WOHS — Williams 10 run, 7:43

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TEAM STATISTICS

WOHS GCS

First Downs 15 7

Total Yards 406 233

Rushes-Yards 43-342 21-168

Fumbles-Lost 2-0 1-0

Com-Att-Int 3-8-0 5-18-2

Passing Yards 64 65

Pen-Yards 3-25 4-30

Punts-Avg. 2-45 4-27.25

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INDIVIDUAL STATISTICS

RUSHING — Greenwood, Kennedy 5-119, Davis 11-39, Todd 2-6, Reed 3-4; West-Oak, Coltrane 21-106, Burgess 6-90, Fountain 10-90, Mesa 2-25, Davis 1-19, Williams 3-12.

PASSING — Greenwood, Reed 5-18-2 65; West-Oak, Burgess 3-8-0 64.

RECEIVING — Greenwood, Kennedy 2-35, Dixon 1-15, White 1-10, Davis 1-5; West-Oak, Williams 2-38, Dobbs 1-26.